USER MANUAL · REV 1.0

UNI VIBE

Quad-Preset MIDI Vibe · a faithful clone of the Uni-Vibe-style photocell modulation · handmade in Austria by Walter Craffonara

NOTE This pedal is a faithful, circuit-for-circuit clone of the Uni-Vibe-style photocell modulation, expanded with functions I added: a relay-switched quad-preset system, a wet/dry MIX control and MIDI. The name “Uni-Vibe” is used only to identify the original circuit this build recreates. CRAFFONARA FX is an independent builder and is not affiliated with, authorised by or endorsed by Dunlop.

1 Overview & Concept

At its core this is a faithful clone of the Uni-Vibe-style circuit — the classic lamp-and-photocell modulation with its unmistakable watery, rotating swirl. MODE switches the character between the chorus/vibe voicing and tremolo.

What I added is the part the original never had: the Speed and Depth controls exist twice and switch on relays, a MIX control blends the effect against your dry signal, and everything is reachable over MIDI — so a slow, shimmering rhythm setting and a fast, deep solo setting are one button or one MIDI message apart.

2 Controls & Connections

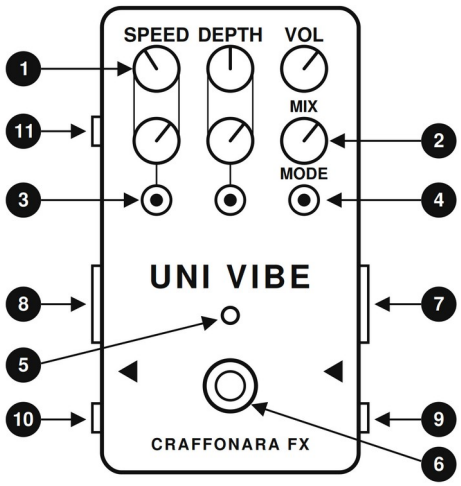


Fig. 1 — Panel and connections

1 SPEED · DEPTH · VOL the main controls for modulation rate, intensity and output level. SPEED and DEPTH each exist twice: an upper pot with a white marker and a lower pot with a red marker.

2 MIX control blends the modulated signal with your dry tone — from a subtle shimmer to the full, deep vibe.

3 PRESET buttons one soft-touch button per channel (SPEED, DEPTH), each driving its own relay. LED ring dark = preset #1 (upper pot, white marker); LED ring lit = preset #2 (lower pot, red marker).

4 MODE button switches between the chorus/vibe voicing and tremolo. Its green LED ring shows the active mode.

5 STATUS LED shows whether the effect is engaged or bypassed. It does NOT indicate which preset is active — that is shown by the LED ring around each PRESET button.

6 FOOTSWITCH silent soft-touch switch, engages / bypasses the effect (relay true bypass).

7 INPUT 6.35 mm mono jack from your guitar or the previous pedal.

8 OUTPUT 6.35 mm mono jack to your amp or the next pedal.

9 MIDI IN TRS socket for incoming MIDI (Type A).

10 MIDI THRU TRS socket passing incoming MIDI on to the next device.

11 POWER 9 V DC, center-negative.

3 The Quad-Preset System

Speed and Depth each exist twice on the panel: an upper pot with a white marker and a lower pot with a red marker. Each channel has its own PRESET button (4), and each button drives its own relay — the two relays work completely independently of one another.

The LED ring around a PRESET button shows which pot that channel is using:

LED ring dark (preset #1) the upper pot with the white marker is active; the lower pot is muted.

LED ring lit (preset #2) the lower pot with the red marker is active; the upper pot is muted.

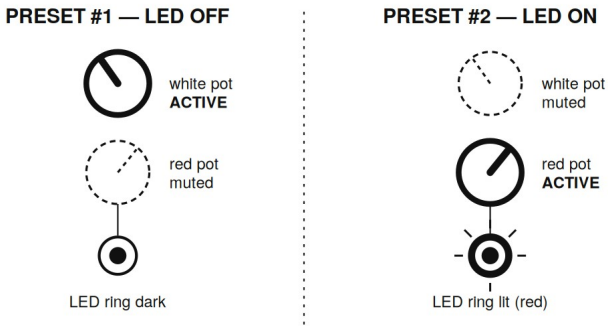


Fig. 2 — Preset states of one channel (Speed or Depth)

Because the two relays switch independently, the two channels give you 2 × 2 = four complete settings in one pedal — a quad-preset system. Recall any of the four by PRESET button or over MIDI: for example a rhythm sound, a lead sound, and two in-between voicings.

> **NOTE** Preset switching is relay-based and click-free. Only the selected pot sits in the signal path, so the muted pot causes no tone loss.

4 Voicing Controls

MIX control sets how much of the modulated signal you hear against the dry tone. Low settings give a gentle shimmer that keeps the dry attack intact; higher settings move towards the full, immersive swirl.

MODE button chooses the chorus/vibe voicing (the classic phase-shifted swirl) or tremolo (amplitude modulation). The green LED ring shows which one is active.

5 MIDI Reference

The pedal responds to MIDI Control Change (CC) messages on its MIDI channel (see the next section).

Over MIDI you can control the following on this pedal:

MODE switch between the chorus/vibe voicing and tremolo.

STATE engage or bypass the effect.

SPEED relay select preset #1 or preset #2 for the SPEED channel.

DEPTH relay select preset #1 or preset #2 for the DEPTH channel.

The SPEED and DEPTH relays are addressed separately, so all four preset combinations are reachable from a controller or DAW — exactly as with the PRESET buttons on the pedal.

6 Setting the MIDI Channel

1. Disconnect the pedal from the power supply.
2. Press and hold the FOOTSWITCH while connecting the power supply — the STATUS LED lights up and starts to flash, showing the pedal is in channel-set mode.
3. Press the FOOTSWITCH as many times as the channel number you want to set (e.g. three times for MIDI channel 3). The STATUS LED flashes back with each press.
4. Press and hold the FOOTSWITCH until the STATUS LED goes dark and the pedal switches off completely.
5. On the next power-up the pedal responds to the new MIDI channel.

7 Power

Run the pedal on 9 V DC, center-negative, from any regulated pedalboard supply. There is no battery compartment.

8 Specifications

Parameter	Value
Type	Vibe / chorus — faithful clone of the Uni-Vibe-style circuit, with a quad-preset system, MIX and MIDI
Controls	SPEED ×2, DEPTH ×2 (relay-switched presets), VOL, MIX, MODE button
Modes	Chorus / vibe and tremolo, selected by the MODE button (green LED ring)
Presets	2 × Speed, 2 × Depth — relay-switched, four combinations
Bypass	Relay true bypass, silent soft-touch footswitch
MIDI	IN + THRU (TRS, Type A), Control Change
Audio I/O	6.35 mm mono input and output
Power	9 V DC, center-negative
Enclosure	Brushed aluminium, CNC-drilled (Hammond 1590B format)

NOTE Trademark notice: “Uni-Vibe” is a trademark of Dunlop Manufacturing, Inc. It is used here purely to describe the original circuit that this independent build recreates. CRAFFONARA FX is not affiliated with, authorised by or endorsed by Dunlop.